Cell Tuition
1-1 PRIVATE TUTORS

NUMBER

Adding and Subtracting Fractions

Name _____ Date _____ No calculator Version 1

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KEY WORDS fraction · common denominator · mixed number · improper fraction · simplest form

A Different denominators ●○○

Remember: Find a number both denominators go into, change both fractions to it, then add or subtract the tops. Simplify at the end.

1. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{3} =$ _____ **b)** $\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____ **c)** $\frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{4} =$ _____ **d)** $\frac{5}{6} + \frac{3}{8} =$ _____

e) $\frac{7}{10} - \frac{2}{5} =$ _____ **f)** $\frac{3}{8} + \frac{5}{12} =$ _____ **g)** $\frac{4}{5} - \frac{2}{3} =$ _____ **h)** $\frac{5}{9} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____

B Mixed numbers ●●○

Remember: Change each mixed number to an improper fraction first. Write the answer back as a mixed number.

2. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $1\frac{1}{2} + 2\frac{1}{3}$ **b)** $2\frac{3}{4} + 1\frac{5}{6}$ **c)** $3\frac{1}{4} - 1\frac{3}{4}$

d) $4\frac{1}{6} - 2\frac{2}{3}$ **e)** $2\frac{2}{5} + 1\frac{7}{10}$ **f)** $5\frac{1}{8} - 2\frac{1}{2}$

g) $1\frac{5}{6} + 3\frac{3}{4}$ **h)** $6\frac{1}{3} - 2\frac{5}{6}$ **i)** $3\frac{3}{8} + 1\frac{5}{12}$

C Negative fractions ●●○

Remember: Treat the signs as you would with whole numbers: $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{4}$ is $-\frac{2}{4}$, because $-3 + 1 = -2$. The denominator never changes sign.

3. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $-\frac{1}{2} + \frac{3}{4}$ **b)** $\frac{2}{5} - \frac{4}{5}$ **c)** $-\frac{2}{3} - \frac{1}{6}$

d) $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{2}$ **e)** $\frac{1}{3} - \frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-\frac{5}{8} + \frac{3}{4}$

g) $-\frac{1}{4} - \frac{2}{3}$ **h)** $\frac{7}{10} - \frac{4}{5}$ **i)** $-\frac{3}{5} + \frac{1}{4}$

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D Negative mixed numbers ●●●

⚠ **Watch out:** A negative mixed number is all negative: $-2\frac{1}{3}$ means $-\frac{7}{3}$, not $-2+\frac{1}{3}$.

4. Work out. Give each answer as a mixed number or a fraction in its simplest form.

a) $-1\frac{1}{2}+2\frac{3}{4}$ **b)** $2\frac{1}{3}-3\frac{1}{2}$ **c)** $-2\frac{1}{4}-1\frac{1}{2}$

d) $1\frac{1}{5}-2\frac{1}{2}$ **e)** $-3\frac{2}{3}+1\frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-1\frac{3}{8}-2\frac{1}{4}$

E Problems ●●●

5. At dawn the temperature was $-1\frac{1}{2}$ °C. By noon it had risen by $2\frac{3}{4}$ °C. What was the temperature at noon?

6. A baker has $2\frac{1}{4}$ kg of flour, uses $1\frac{2}{3}$ kg, then buys another $1\frac{1}{2}$ kg. How much flour is there now?

7. A share price fell by $1\frac{3}{8}$ dollars on Monday and rose by $\frac{3}{4}$ of a dollar on Tuesday. What was the change over the two days?

8. A plank is $3\frac{1}{5}$ m long. Pieces of $1\frac{3}{4}$ m and $\frac{3}{4}$ m are cut off. How long is the piece that is left?

★ Extension

9. Work out $-\frac{1}{2}+\frac{3}{4}-\frac{5}{6}$.

10. What must be added to $-2\frac{1}{3}$ to make $\frac{1}{2}$?

11. Two fractions add to $\frac{1}{6}$. One of them is $-\frac{3}{4}$. What is the other?

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NUMBER

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A Different denominators ●○○

Remember: Find a number both denominators go into, change both fractions to it, then add or subtract the tops. Simplify at the end.

1. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $\frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{5} =$ _____ **b)** $\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{4} =$ _____ **c)** $\frac{3}{4} - \frac{2}{5} =$ _____ **d)** $\frac{5}{6} + \frac{1}{4} =$ _____

e) $\frac{9}{10} - \frac{3}{5} =$ _____ **f)** $\frac{5}{8} + \frac{1}{12} =$ _____ **g)** $\frac{4}{5} - \frac{1}{3} =$ _____ **h)** $\frac{7}{9} + \frac{1}{6} =$ _____

B Mixed numbers ●●○

Remember: Change each mixed number to an improper fraction first. Write the answer back as a mixed number.

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a) $1\frac{1}{3} + 2\frac{1}{2}$ **b)** $2\frac{1}{4} + 1\frac{5}{6}$ **c)** $3\frac{1}{5} - 1\frac{3}{5}$

d) $4\frac{1}{8} - 2\frac{3}{4}$ **e)** $2\frac{3}{5} + 1\frac{9}{10}$ **f)** $5\frac{1}{6} - 2\frac{1}{2}$

g) $1\frac{7}{8} + 3\frac{1}{4}$ **h)** $6\frac{1}{4} - 2\frac{5}{6}$ **i)** $3\frac{5}{8} + 1\frac{7}{12}$

C Negative fractions ●●○

Remember: Treat the signs as you would with whole numbers: $-\frac{3}{4} + \frac{1}{4}$ is $-\frac{2}{4}$, because $-3 + 1 = -2$. The denominator never changes sign.

3. Work out. Give each answer in simplest form.

a) $-\frac{1}{2} + \frac{2}{3}$ **b)** $\frac{3}{7} - \frac{5}{7}$ **c)** $-\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{8}$

d) $-\frac{2}{5} + \frac{3}{10}$ **e)** $\frac{1}{4} - \frac{5}{6}$ **f)** $-\frac{7}{8} + \frac{1}{2}$

g) $-\frac{1}{3} - \frac{3}{4}$ **h)** $\frac{9}{10} - \frac{3}{5}$ **i)** $-\frac{2}{3} + \frac{1}{5}$

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d) $1\frac{1}{6}-2\frac{2}{3}$ **e)** $-3\frac{3}{4}+1\frac{5}{8}$ **f)** $-1\frac{5}{8}-2\frac{1}{2}$

E Problems ●●●

5. At dawn the temperature was $-2\frac{1}{4}$ °C. By noon it had risen by $3\frac{1}{2}$ °C. What was the temperature at noon?

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★ Extension

9. Work out $-\frac{2}{3}+\frac{3}{4}-\frac{1}{6}$.

10. What must be added to $-1\frac{1}{4}$ to make $\frac{2}{3}$?

11. Two fractions add to $\frac{1}{4}$. One of them is $-\frac{2}{3}$. What is the other?

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